Vol. 23 - Dec 2024

RAYS

A Brighton's Publication

© BRIGHTON INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL, Nardaha, Raipur

About RAYS

Rays is a tri-monthly newsletter published by the Brighton International School. Brighton is situated near Vidhan Sabha in Raipur (C.G). Rays is a compilation of articles by students of Brighton aiming to promote literary zest amongst the students.

Editorial Board - Students - Aanya Sharma (Head Girl), Divyansh Ojha (Head Boy), Harshita Niwalkar, Avishi Anand (VII), Soumya Jain, Shaurya Grover (X), Shreyashree Satpathy (VI), Siddhi Dwivedi (VI), Veronica Sen (VI), Megha Sahu (XI), Shreya Mehra (IV), Nishtha Joshi (VII), Saransh Pandey (VII)

www.brightoninternational.in



AN INTERVIEW WITH VICE-PRINCIPAL MA'AM



Q. Did you plan to become an educator or it was a coincidence or some incidents happened with you?

Ans. I didn't have a set plan to become an educator during my school days; however, I always felt compelled to teach others new things whether it was by tutoring classmates or volunteering in different school activities. Over time, I realized how much I loved working with pupils and supporting their growth. It wasn't one specific incident, but rather a series of experiences where I saw how powerful education could be in shaping someone's life. Eventually, I decided to pursue teaching because I wanted to help students attain their potential, just as the educators who inspired me to move in this path.

Q. What challenges you face every day as an educator?

Ans. One challenge is making sure that every student feels supported, because each of you learn in different ways. Another challenge is balancing the task, like maintaining academic standards, school activities, and to run the system smoothly, along with paying attention to the students' needs. Despite these challenges, it's so rewarding to see students succeed and grow, and that's what keeps me motivated every day.

Q. What do you believe are the most important skills or values that students should develop during their time at school?

Ans. At Brighton, 'RESPECT' is the most important value we uphold. This includes respect for your parents, teachers, classmates, and yourself. When we respect each other, we create a safe and supportive environment where everyone can thrive. Along with that, building good communication and teamwork abilities is essential. It's also important to learn discipline and develop resilience-the ability to face challenges, learn from mistakes, and keep going, even when things get tough. School is about developing as an individual, not just about academics, and these values and abilities will help you thrive in school and in life.

Q. How do you stay updated with developments in education, and how do you incorporate new ideas into your practice?

Ans. Since the world, and the way we learn, are constantly evolving, it is crucial to stay up to date in education. To keep up, I read educational journals, attend workshops, conferences, trainings and connect with other educators. There are always new ideas and techniques being shared, and it's important to stay open to them. I also like to listen to feedback from the students, teachers and parents because they all bring valuable perspectives about what works and what doesn't in the classroom.

Q. Apart from being a Vice- Principal, what inspires you to work as a teacher in this school?

Ans. That's an intriguing question! While being a vice-principal is a significant part of my role, my passion for teaching is what truly inspires me every day. What motivates me the most is seeing the growth and progress of students. There's nothing more rewarding than watching a student discover something new, overcome a challenge, or achieve something they didn't think was possible.

Q. What initiatives are taken at Brighton to support the students academically who struggle and the ones who are a step ahead from others?

Ans. The students who need more attention in academics have remedial classes to help them, and on the other hand, students who are a step ahead have opportunities to prepare for Olympiads/competitive exams and pursue their hobbies in stay hours, and teachers guide them steadily in their areas of interest.

Q. If you were in place of us, what type of teacher would you prefer for yourself?

Ans. I would want a teacher who is compassionate, understanding, and really interested in helping students to succeed if I were in your shoes. I would value a teacher who is enthusiastic about subject, makes learning enjoyable and engaging, and encourages me to think critically and on my own to increase my self-confidence.

Q. What advice would you give to students to achieve success in academics and in life?

Ans. I will advise you to stay curious and never stop learning. Challenge yourself, be open to new ideas, and don't be afraid of making mistakes, because that's how we learn and grow. In life, one of the most important things is to be kind and respectful to others. Also, take care of your mental and physical well-being.

Success isn't just about grades or achievements; it's about developing resilience, staying positive, and always striving to be the best version of yourself, no matter what challenges come your way.

Q. What kind of achievement would you consider most commendable – academics, co-curricular or personal growth?

Ans. Each of the three aspects is significant in its own way. Academic achievements open the doors to new opportunities. Co-curricular achievements show your creativity, teamwork, passion, and hone leadership skills. However, I would say that personal growth is perhaps the most commendable achievement of all.

Q. How do you think celebrating students' achievements impacts the overall environment of school (development of a child)?

Ans. Celebrating students' achievements plays a vital role in a positive school environment. When achievements are celebrated, it motivates the students to keep working hard and boosts their confidence. When students see their peers being celebrated, it encourages them to believe in their own potential, too. It creates an atmosphere where everyone feels encouraged to do their best, whether it's in academics, sports, or personal growth.

Q. We all know that the school is well balanced but do you think something still needs to be looked after?

Ans. While our school is indeed well balanced, there's always room for improvement, as education is constantly evolving. One area I think we can always look forward is ensuring that every student feels fully supported, whether it's academically, emotionally, or socially. We are always looking for ways to ensure that all students feel valued, whether to excel in their studies, involvement in co-curricular activities, or facing challenges. We are always exploring how we can integrate new teaching methods or technology to make learning even more engaging and effective. So, while we're in a good place, there's always something we can improve, because our goal is to keep growing and finding new ways to help each student succeed.

Interviewed by -

Harshita Niwalkar, Avishi Anand, Grade - VII

MINDSPARK








MindSpark, Brighton's annual inter-school competition, held on 25th and 26th of October 2024. The experience will etch in our memory. As the Head boy & Head girl of Brighton, We had the privilege and responsibility to govern and guide the Mindspark competition, a two-day event that brought together 14 esteemed schools with 700 students and 30 escort teachers across the city. The competition was a mix of cultural, sports, and tech events, and we both were amazed at how it showcased the sensational talent of the scholars from different schools.

At the outset, we both knew that organizing such a large-scale event was not a cake walk. We had to synchronize with teachers, students and external participants, making sure very thing runs smoothly. One of the toughest challenges we faced was managing the schedule. With so many events happening at simultaneously, we both divided our duties and made sure that participants were always in the right place at the right time. Balancing between the different categories-cultural, sports, and tech-was tricky too, as each one needed different resources and preparations.

First day once the inauguration ceremony began, everything seemed to calm. However, as the inauguration ceremony commenced, the chaos transformed into an organized celebration. Watching the dignified lamp-lighting ceremony and the vibrant welcome dance filled us with pride and motivation.

Throughout the day, we were on our toes at different venues to ensure everything was proceeding smoothly. It was a demanding task, but seeing the enthusiasm, dedication, and competitive spirit of the students was incredibly motivating. By the end of the day, we felt exhausted but fulfilled, knowing that everything was conducted according to plan.

The second day was even more exciting, with cultural activities and sports in full swing. The colourful costumes of the dancers, the stunning solo instrumental performances, and the electrifying volleyball and cricket matches brought the campus to life. Despite of all the challenges, the joy of watching cricket and volleyball was the favourite part. It was so much fun to see them in action. We learned a lot through it all. We learned to manage time by being calm and how to communicate under pressure. The biggest lesson what we learnt was how to manage and work with such a diverse group of people.

The two day event concluded with a grand closing ceremony and prize distribution ceremony, leaving us all with a sense of accomplishment. The experience will always hold a special place in our heart, and we'll forever cherish the trust and responsibility the school management placed in us.

Aanya Sharma - Head Girl
Divyansh Ojha - Head Boy

THE INSEF EXPERIENCE
(INTERNATIONAL SCIENCE & ENGINEERING FAIR)

On December 8, 2024, we stepped into the exhibition center of INSEF 2024 (Indian Science and Engineering Fair). We walked in with blazing determination with an innovation project, 'Blind Vision'. Blind Vision wasn't just our project, it was our ambition, and days of hard work, to win and build something innovative for the visually impaired people.

The atmosphere buzzed with excitement. Teams from across the region stood with their projects, but our focus was unshaken. Our eyes reflected one goal: victory.

The first judge arrived, and we started strong. But then, a sudden lag in our system threw us off. We panicked, but we fixed the glitch quickly and continued. The judge appreciated our effort, but we knew we had stumbled. It wasn't our best, but it wasn't the end.

The second judge, an expert in machine learning, tested us rigorously. Some questions pushed us and we answered confidently, but a few left us uncertain. The round ended on a neutral note. Doubts crept in, but we refused to loose hope and stood ignited with a desire to win.

Now the time was for the third round. This judge was very curious to know about our project. We poured our passion into the presentation, explaining every detail. He praised our innovative idea and left us with a remark 'This is a great project' which we cleverly utilized to present another handy feature of our project, that was reading handwritings and texts for the visually impaired and provide them a speech output.

We felt accomplished after third round; we both sat and started having refreshment, suddenly Mr. Narayan Iyer, the President of the Science Society of India, approached us with a pen and Clipboard in his hand and asked us to explain our project. We paused our refreshment and gave it everything, explaining every detail, while nailing every question with a perfect answer, his calm and a fellow tech geek attitude allowed us to give him a great explanation of Blind Vision. His pat and smile reignited our determination.

The award ceremony began after a few hours. Honorable mentions passed, then bronze medals. As the silver medals were announced, our hearts raced. A top project we admired won silver, leaving us stunned. Our mind questioning us if we even have a chance to win, or if the odds are on our side and we might have bagged a gold, Me and my teammate asked each other "Could we really have done it?"

The next thing we heard was "And the gold medal goes to... Team tech-14 Blind Vision!" Time stopped. Then, pure joy. We exchanged a victorious dap and stepped onto the stage. The applause gave us a brink of satisfaction as Mr. Iyer bestowed us with medals and certificates and a ticket to nationals round. The feeling was unreal.

We celebrated with our mentors Mr. Sagar Sahu, Mr. Lukesh Baghel & Mr. Kunal Urkude. Snapping photos and sharing snacks as a victory meal. Winning this competition once again fueled our innovative spirit, and strengthened our desire to push boundaries and create even more impactful solutions.

Soumya Jain
Shaurya Grover
Grade-X



EXCERPTS OF ANNUAL ATHLETIC MEET

4th Annual Athletic Meet at Brighton International was a much awaited event. On 25 November 2024 the countdown started with the Mascot, Mickey Mouse Revealing Ceremony by respected Chairman Sir. It ignited the spark in Brightonites for the upcoming 2 days athletic meet. On 29 November the meet commenced with the torch lighting ceremony by Mr. Tarunesh Parihar, a renowned sports administrator and former U-19 Team India Manager in selection committee. Students competed in junior, sub-junior & senior categories and demonstrated a deeper comprehension of the virtues that sports represent: teamwork, discipline and respect. As we bid adieu to this years' meet on 30 January 2024, we carried with us the memories and the lessons of the unyielding spirit of 'Khelo Brighton'.








This year's Athletic Meet was a golden opportunity for me to showcase my talent. I participated in the 'Long Jump'. Although I did not win, but I learned a valuable lesson'success can't be achieved easily'. My jump was almost perfect but I fell just a centimeter short of the passing line, which kept me from succeeding. However, this experience taught me that winning or losing isn't the most important thing, it's about creating new memories and giving your best. I thoroughly enjoyed the Athletic Meet, which was filled with unforgettable moments, lessons, and fun. I aim to win the 'Long Jump' next year and will put in more effort, as practice makes a man perfect. This experience has motivated me to work harder and never give up. After all, every failure is a stepping stone to success.

Shreyashree Satpathy
Class VI – A

Athletic Meet which was held on 29 and 30 November 2024 was an excellent day. I really enjoyed those two days as it didn't gave me a chance to participate but also gave a break from continuous studies. It was a very special day for all of us, me and my friends played a lot of different sports. I participated in shot put and it was an amazing experience. All the teachers took great care of us and no one was hurt. The day was filled with laughter, joy, activities and togetherness. It was an awesome and tiring day.

Siddhi Dwivedi
Class VI – G

I recently had an opportunity to participate in the annual athletic meet, where I competed in the 100-meter and 200-meter races, specializing in skipping. Although I did not emerge victorious in either event, but I gave it my best effort and performed to the best of my abilities. I was happy with my overall performance, despite not winning,I gained valuable experience and insight into areas where I can improve. Despite not achieving the desired outcome, I am not discouraged andlooking forward to participate in next year's athletic meet. In fact, I am more determined than ever to work on my weaknesses, build on my strengths, and come back stronger and more competitive than before. I will continue to practice and strengthen my skipping skills to deliver a better performance next time. With perseverance, dedication, and hard work, I am confident that I can achieve my goals and make a positive impact in the athletic meet

Veronica Sen
Class VI – F

ECHOES OF YOUNG VOICES IN PARLIAMENT

Youth Parliament, a very interesting act where we, the students from class IX and XI enacted as the MP's in the Parliament. I always wished to be in the youth parliament when I saw the seniors dressed up as politicians and the set prepared in the auditorium just like the real Parliament with the cameras,lights, sound on. And, I got the golden opportunity this year to play the role as the Prime Minister in the Youth Parliament. It was an unforgettable experience to be a part of this journey. Our mentors vigourously worked on our body language, pronunciations and speeches until we really spoke like the politicians, I was quite nervous, as adopting the character of the Prime Minister wasn't easy, but our mentor guided me so well that slowly I became confident enough to speak infront of the camera. Before the D-day, we all practiced together with great zeal and enthusiasm. I still remember that, Alveera Didi, who asked the Q. 101 from the opposition, was quite nervous during the practice and was forgetting her lines frequently. She wasn't able to speak her lines, then Gunmala Ma'am said, "You don't have to be casual but be Amit Shah", which was quite a hilarious comment. And then she herself started acting like him showing us how he speaks with confidence and rage in eyes. Tarandeep Didi, who asked question from opposition was speaking so softly as if she was just politely requesting the ruling party to give her the answer, it's better if they do, and if not,that's also good. But, despite all this they performed the best in the main act. In the Breach of Privilege, they pointed out the opposition leader to be called as "Bulb ke neeche baitha Macchar" and the fact that they were roasting their own leader was quite funny to witness at that moment. Our social studies teachers, pointed out our mistakes, but also encouraged us to do our best. They compared us with other personalities and actors which was the funniest part. We laughed, learnt and shared beautiful moments together. The best part was the day, when the actual execution of our hardwork happened. The cameras, the lights, the setup, these things made me quite a bit nervous. And, the word "Action", transformed us into real political figures trying to put the matter on the table in the Parliament. The change felt was magical and unreal. At the end, when we received a huge round of applause from the audience and teachers, that was the moment where I felt proud of my hardwork. I am very thankful to all the teachers who gave me this opportunity and were with us throughout the practice. I won't forget this Youth Parliament ever in my life!

Megha Sahu
Class **XI**



INTERVIEW WITH DEEPIKA SONI– MATRON AT BRIGHTON INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL



Q1. Didi, can you tell us about yourself and your family?

Ans. My name is Deepika Soni, I am from Nardaha village, Raipur. I have two children, one boy and one girl. My son is 18 years old and my daughter is 20 years old. My husband works here as bus conductor.

Q2. Didi how many years you have been here at Brighton International School and what is your daily routine like?

Ans. I have been working in school for last 8 years. I joined school after my husband started working here. I wake at 4 a.m. in the morning and prepare breakfast for my family and then we both come to school. I start my day with cleaning and managing the things properly for the primary students so that school's functionality doesn't get hampered, this work takes a few hours. Once the senior classes disperse, we again start with cleaning and arranging the things in their place for the next day. That is how we manage our time and the cleanliness for both wings.

Q3. What do you like most about Brighton Didi?

Ans. I love everything here. I like the friendly behavior of all the staff and the dignitaries. The way people treat us here feels like we are at our home. The children are quite cooperative and disciplined here. I am thankful to Shobha ma'am, as she helps all of us and guides us whenever needed.

Q4. What do you like to do in your free time?

Ans. I love to cook for my family. I like to make the dried food (bari, papad) etc. during winters. I find time to do all this apart from my working schedule.

Interviewed by-
Shreya Mehra
Class-IV (G)

A WORLD OF WONDERS: A LOOK INTO OUR SCHOOL LIBRARY









Reading is an essential yet overlooked skill. Our school library is the vibrant heart of learning, creativity, and discovery. With a rich collection of books, resources, and reference materials, it acts as a gateway to knowledge, supporting academic excellence and fostering personal growth. Our library is in the activity building, as we climb the stairs to second floor, a huge library's inviting atmosphere, featuring cosy reading corners and spacious study areas, is the ideal space for students to focus, relax and explore new ideas.

Students of all grades seem to enjoy their visits to the library as they dive into the lucrative world of reading. One of the most exciting features in library is 'Storytelling Stars' programme, where students narrate stories to earn stars, and when they gain a series of stars they are rewarded with Reader's Badge, which is a symbol of reader's pride. The curious and enthusiastic readers from grade I to XII, thrive for it. Our library has a theme, which changes monthly. It takes us to the tour around the world through themes like mythology, encyclopaedia, graphic novels, mystery, adventure etc.

The library's influence extends beyond its walls, positively impacting our school community. It plays a central role in enhancing student engagement, providing resources for academic success, and creating a culture of collaboration and creativity. Apart from 2 to 3 library classes per week, our library is a buzz in the recess hours too, as all of us rush to the library to read our favourite minutes. I love being there.

I usually go with my friend to sit on our favourite couch and have some peaceful reading time. Our librarian Mrs.Reena Shukla is always available to guide research &recommend new reads, ensuring the library remains an essential resource in every student's journey.

Nishtha Joshi
Class **VII-F**

SCHOOL TRIP TO PACHMARHI

My school trip to Pachmarhi was an unforgettable experience. The excitement began at the railway station when I met my friends, and we boarded the train together. The trip was adventurous. We chatted, played games like Ludo, UNO, and word chain, and laughed the whole evening. After having dinner, we all went to bed, dreaming about the adventures ahead.

Next morning, we reached our destination and took a bus to Pachmarhi. The views of the Satpura ranges on the way were so beautiful that is hard to describe. Once we reached the hotel, we had breakfast, got ready, and headed out to explore.

Our exploration journey started from Bison Lodge, a museum with information about wildlife and animal species. After that, we went to Bee Falls. We had to trek about 500 meters to reach the waterfall, and it was totally worth reaching there. We clicked many pictures and captured memories. Suddenly, it started raining, and we ran back to our jeeps. We had lunch, took a nap, and then we embarked on journey towards Reechgarh Caves and Dhoopgarh.

Reechgarh Caves were exciting to be explored as we walked through dark tunnel, a bit scary but was fun exploring the caves. Later, we went to Dhoopgarh, the highest point in Pachmarhi, to watch the sunset. The view was breathtaking, even after such a tiring day, we watched a documentary at night.

On the second day, we trekked 6 kilometers to Ramya Kund, a freshwater pond in the middle of the jungle. The trek was full of fun-we made tattoos using fern leaves and spotted different plants and trees. Once we reached, we swam in the pond and splashed water on each other. It felt like we had turned into singers there because everyone was singing happily. At night, we had a great time dancing and singing.

The last day was full of adventurous activities, we did rock climbing, rappelling, sky cycling, valley crossing, and ziplining. I was scared at first, but I tried my best. These activities helped me face my fears, though I couldn't finish all of them but I promised myself I would do better next time. After this, we visited the Jatashankar Temple to seek blessings from Lord Shiva.

Finally, we boarded the train back to Raipur. This trip was more than just fun-it taught me to enjoy nature and face challenges with confidence. I will always remember these beautiful moments and the time spent with my friends.







Saransh Pandey
Class **VII-C**